Sunday sermon · Abiding in the Vine

John 15:1–8

> CENTRAL MESSAGE
> Fruit comes from remaining in Jesus, not from trying harder.

Introduction

Have you ever watched someone prune a rose bush? It looks like they are hurting it. But a few months later the bush is full of flowers. Jesus says his Father does something like that with us.

Point 1: Jesus is the true vine

Psalm 80:8–16

Israel was often called God's vine, and it did not bear the fruit God looked for. Jesus says: I am the true vine. Everything the vine was meant to be, he is.

APPLICATION
Our life with God does not start with what we do, but with who he is.

Point 2: We bear fruit by remaining

A branch does not strain to make grapes. It stays joined to the vine, and the fruit comes. The word "remain" comes again and again in verses 4 to 10.

APPLICATION
This week, begin each morning with a short passage before anything else.

Point 3: The Father is glorified

Conclusion

Stay close to him this week: begin each day with his words.